



# Maxim Romanov

*Emmy Noether Junior Research Group Leader*, DFG project “The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE): Algorithmic Analysis into Social History” (**EIS1600**), Universität Hamburg, Asien-Afrika-Institut

*Position* Emmy Noether Junior Research Group Leader, DFG project “The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE): Algorithmic Analysis into Social History” (**EIS1600**), Universität Hamburg, Asien-Afrika-Institut

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## Employment

- 2021–2027 *Emmy Noether Junior Research Group Leader*, DFG project “The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE): Algorithmic Analysis into Social History” (**EIS1600**), Universität Hamburg, Asien-Afrika-Institut
- 2018–2021 *Senior Research Fellow*, ERC project “Knowledge, Information Technology, & the Arabic Book” (**KITAB**), PI Prof. Dr. Sarah Bowen Savant, Aga Khan University–London, Institute for the Study of Muslim Civilisations
- 2017–2021 *Universitätsassistent für Digital Humanities*, Universität Wien, Institut für Geschichte
- 2015–2017 *Research Fellow*, Universität Leipzig, Institut für Informatik, Lehrstuhl für Digital Humanities
- 2013–2015 *Postdoctoral Associate*, Tufts University, Department of Classics & Perseus Project
- 2006–2012 *Graduate Student Instructor*, University of Michigan, Department of Near Eastern Studies
- 2004–2006 *Junior Researcher*, Institute of Oriental Manuscripts of the Russian Academy of Sciences (formerly St. Petersburg Branch of the Institute of Oriental Studies), St. Petersburg (**IOM RAS**)

## Education

- 2006–2013 Ph.D. (December 2013) and M.A. (April 2010) in Near Eastern Studies (Arabic & Islamic Studies), University of Michigan, Ann Arbor ([official record](#))
- 2001–2004 Post-graduate program in Islamic Studies, Institute of Oriental Manuscripts of the Russian Academy of Sciences, St. Petersburg
- 1999–2001 St. Petersburg State University, Faculty of Oriental Studies (History of the Arab Countries)
- 1998–2001 Specialist in Sociology (B.A. & M.A. equivalent), St. Petersburg State University, Faculty of Sociology
- 1999–2001 Baltic State Technical University, Faculty of Humanities (Political Science), St. Petersburg

## Digital Humanities Projects

- 2021–2027 **EIS1600: The Evolution of Islamic Societies (c. 600–1600 CE): Algorithmic Analysis into Social History**. Emmy Noether Junior Research Group, DFG (#445975300), Universität Hamburg. Principal investigator. [Project page](http://eis1600.aai.uni-hamburg.de) · [eis1600.aai.uni-hamburg.de](http://eis1600.aai.uni-hamburg.de)
- 2014– **OpenITI: Open Islamicate Texts Initiative** (2014–2016: OpenArabic). Co-PI with Matthew T. Miller (University of Maryland) and Sarah Bowen Savant (Aga Khan University–London). About 8,700 titles by over 3,300 authors, some 861 million words (most conservatively; all texts amount to 2.4 billion words). [Project page](#) · [github.com/OpenITI](https://github.com/OpenITI)
- 2014– **OpenITI mARkdown**. A light-weight annotation scheme for Arabic-script texts: structural, morphological, and semantic tagging designed as a research method rather than an exchange format. [Description](#)
- 2014– **al-Turayyā Project**. A gazetteer (over 2,000 toponyms) and a geospatial model of the early Islamic world, with Masoumeh Seydi. [Project page](#) · [althurayya.github.io](https://althurayya.github.io)
- 2025 **OpenITI NgramReader** and **Book Classification** (T10 model; published as “M10 Book Classification”). Two online applications published as appendices to *Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies* (Brill, 2026). [Project page](#)
- 2019– **OpenITI AOCF: Arabic-script OCR Catalyst Project**. Co-led with Matthew T. Miller, Sarah Bowen Savant, David Smith, and Raffaele Viglianti; funded by the Andrew W. Mellon Foundation. [openiti.org](https://openiti.org)
- 2018–2021 **KITAB: Knowledge, Information Technology, and the Arabic Book**. ERC project (PI Sarah Bowen Savant); senior research fellow responsible for corpus development and text-reuse analysis. [kitab-project.org](http://kitab-project.org)
- 2015 **Classical Arabic Through the Words of the Prophet: A Frequency-Based Ḥadīṭ Reader**. Computationally generated teaching materials (Perseus Project & Department of Classics, Tufts Uni-

versity). [PDF](#)

## Publications

key = key contribution to digital humanities in the field · pr = peer-reviewed · oa = open access  
books

- 2026 *new* **Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Proposition for the Field**. Handbook of Oriental Studies, Section 1: The Near and Middle East, vol. 199. Leiden and Boston: Brill, 2026. E-book (PDF) published 1 September 2026, ISBN 978-90-04-76053-0; hardback 1 October 2026, ISBN 978-90-04-76052-3. [[key](#), pr] » [Brill \(order or read online\)](#) · [Online supplement: figures \(figshare, open\)](#) · [Appendix 1: NgramReader](#) · [Appendix 2: Book Classification \(T10\)](#)
- articles and book chapters
- 2019 **1001 Morphological Patterns: Algorithmically Generated Materials for Teaching Classical Arabic**. In *Innovations and Traditions in Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Festschrift in Honor of Professor Oleg I. Red'kin*, 262–274. St. Petersburg: St. Petersburg University Press, 2019. [pr] » [PDF](#) · [Publisher](#)
- 2019 **Studying the History of the Arabic Language: Language Technology and a Large-Scale Historical Corpus**. Yonatan Belinkov\*, Alexander Magidow\*, Alberto Barrón-Cedeño, Avi Shmidman, and **Maxim Romanov** (\* equal contribution). *Language Resources and Evaluation* 53 (2019): 771–805. Springer. [pr] » [DOI](#) · [PDF \(author version\)](#)
- 2018 **A Digital Humanities for Premodern Islamic History**. Roundtable on Digital Humanities, *International Journal of Middle East Studies* 50, no. 1 (2018): 129–134. Cambridge University Press. [[key](#), pr] » [DOI](#) · [PDF](#) · [Read as a note](#)
- 2018 **Digitizing the Textual Heritage of the Premodern Islamicate World: Principles and Plans**. Matthew Thomas Miller, **Maxim G. Romanov**, and Sarah Bowen Savant (alphabetically). Roundtable on Digital Humanities, *International Journal of Middle East Studies* 50, no. 1 (2018): 103–109. Cambridge University Press. [[key](#), pr] » [DOI](#) · [PDF](#)
- 2017 **Algorithmic Analysis of Medieval Arabic Biographical Collections**. *Speculum* 92, no. S1 (2017): S226–S246. [[key](#), pr, oa] » [DOI](#) · [PDF](#)
- 2017 **Observations of a Medieval Quantitative Historian?**. *Der Islam* 94, no. 2 (2017): 462–495. [[key](#), pr] » [DOI](#) · [PDF](#)
- 2017 **Important New Developments in Arabographic Optical Character Recognition (OCR)**. Benjamin Kiessling, Matthew Thomas Miller, **Maxim Romanov**, and Sarah Bowen Savant (alphabetically). *al-ʿUṣūr al-Wuṣṭā: The Journal of Middle East Medievalists* 25 (2017): 1–13. [[key](#), pr, oa] » [PDF](#) · [Read as a note](#)
- 2016 **After the Classical World: The Social Geography of Islam (c. 600–1300 CE)**. In *Ars Islamica: Festschrift in Honor of Stanislav Mikhailovich Prozorov*, edited by Mikhail Piotrovsky and Alikber Alikberov, 247–277. Moscow: Vostochnaya Literatura (Russian Academy of Sciences, Institute of Oriental Studies), 2016. [[key](#), pr] » [PDF](#)
- 2016 **Digital Age, Digital Methods**. In *Ars Islamica: Festschrift in Honor of Stanislav Mikhailovich Prozorov*, edited by Mikhail Piotrovsky and Alikber Alikberov, 129–156. Moscow: Vostochnaya Literatura (Russian Academy of Sciences, Institute of Oriental Studies), 2016. [pr] » [PDF](#)
- 2016 **Toward Abstract Models for Islamic History**. In *The Digital Humanities and Islamic & Middle East Studies*, edited by Elias Muhanna, 117–149. Berlin: De Gruyter, 2016. ISBN 978-3-11-037454-4. [[key](#), pr] » [PDF](#) · [DOI](#)
- 2014 **Toward the Digital History of the Pre-Modern Muslim World: Developing Text-Mining Techniques for the Study of Arabic Biographical Collections**. In *Analysis of Ancient and Medieval Texts and Manuscripts: Digital Approaches*, edited by Tara L. Andrews and Caroline Macé, 229–244. Turnhout: Brepols, 2014. [pr] » [DOI](#) · [PDF](#)
- 2012 **Dreaming Ḥanbalites: Dream-Tales in Prosopographical Dictionaries**. In *Dreams and Visions in Islamic Societies*, edited by Özgen Felek and Alexander Knysh, 31–50. Albany: SUNY Press, 2012. ISBN 978-1-4384-3993-8. [pr] » [PDF](#)
- 2007 **The Term *Ṣūfī*: Spiritualizing Simple Words**. *Pismennyye Pamyatniki Vostoka / Written Monuments of the Orient* 5 (2007): 149–159. [pr] » [PDF](#)
- 2005 **Electronic Databases on Islam in Arabic, Persian, and English: A Review**. Stanislav M. Prozorov and **Maxim Romanov**. *Pismennyye Pamyatniki Vostoka / Written Monuments of the Orient* 2, no. 3 (2005): 240–257. With a summary in English. [pr] » [PDF](#) · [PDF \(IOM RAS\)](#)
- 2004 **The Paradigm of the Science of Hadīṭ (*ʿilm al-ḥadīṭ*)**. *Vostok / Oriens* 5 (2004): 5–11. With a summary in English. [pr] » [PDF \(IOM RAS\)](#)
- 2009 **Hadīṭ Reports in Ibn al-Jawzī's (d. 597/1201) System of Argumentation, Based on His *Tal-***

- bīs Iblīs* (“Devil’s Delusions”). *Khristianskii Vostok / Christian Orient*, n.s. 5 (XI) (2009): 310–316. Moscow: Indrik (Russian Academy of Sciences and the State Hermitage). Accepted for publication in 2003. [pr] » [PDF](#) · [PDF \(IOM RAS\)](#)
- 2003 **Principles and Procedures of Extracting and Processing Data from Arabic Sources: Historical and Biographical Sources**. Stanislav M. Prozorov and Maxim Romanov. *Vostok / Oriens* 4 (2003): 117–127. With a summary in English. [pr] » [PDF](#) · [PDF \(IOM RAS\)](#)  
conference papers, proceedings, and posters
- 2023 **Enhancing State-of-the-Art NLP Models for Classical Arabic**. Tariq Yousef, Lisa Mischer, Hamid Reza Hakimi, and Maxim Romanov. In *Proceedings of the Ancient Language Processing Workshop (RANLP 2023, Varna, 8 September 2023)*, 160–169. [pr, oa] » [PDF \(proceedings\)](#) · [ACL Anthology](#)
- 2022 **Establishing Parameters for Stylometric Authorship Attribution of 19th-Century Arabic Books and Periodicals**. Till Grallert and Maxim Romanov. In *Digital Humanities 2022: Book of Abstracts* (University of Tokyo), 346–348. [pr]
- 2019 **Open Islamicate Texts Initiative: A Machine-Readable Corpus of Texts Produced in the Premodern Islamicate World (poster)**. Maxim Romanov, Matthew Thomas Miller, Sarah Bowen Savant, and Masoumeh Seydi. In *Digital Humanities 2019 Conference Papers* (Utrecht University, 9–12 July 2019). [[key](#), pr, oa] » [Abstract](#) · [Poster](#)
- 2019 **al-Ṭurayyā, the Gazetteer and the Geospatial Model of the Early Islamic World**. Maxim Romanov and Masoumeh Seydi. In *Digital Humanities 2019 Conference Papers* (Utrecht University, 9–12 July 2019). [[key](#), pr, oa] » [Abstract](#)
- 2019 **Orbis-in-a-Box (OIB): Modeling Historical Geographical Networks (poster)**. Maxim Romanov, Masoumeh Seydi, James Baillie, Karl Grossner, and Rainer Simon. In *Digital Humanities 2019 Conference Papers* (Utrecht University, 9–12 July 2019). [[key](#), pr, oa] » [Abstract](#) · [Poster](#)
- 2017 **Premodern Geographical Description: Data Retrieval and Identification**. Masoumeh Seydi, Maxim Romanov, and Chiara Palladino (alphabetically). In *Proceedings of the 11th Workshop on Geographic Information Retrieval (GIR’17)*, 4:1–4:10. New York: ACM Press, 2017. [pr] » [DOI](#) · [PDF](#)
- 2016 **Shamela: A Large-Scale Historical Arabic Corpus**. Yonatan Belinkov, Alexander Magidow, Maxim Romanov, Avi Shmidman, and Moshe Koppel (alphabetically). In *Proceedings of the Workshop on Language Technology Resources and Tools for Digital Humanities (LT4DH)*, 45–53. Osaka, 11–17 December 2016. [pr, oa] » [PDF](#) · [ACL Anthology](#)  
dissertation
- 2013 **Computational Reading of Arabic Biographical Collections with Special Reference to Preaching in the Sunnī World (661–1300 CE)**. Ph.D. dissertation, University of Michigan, 2013. [[key](#)] » [Deep Blue \(U of Michigan\)](#) · [PDF \(46 MB\)](#) · [Read as a note](#)  
working papers, preprints, and teaching materials
- 2017 **Algorithmic Analysis of Medieval Arabic Biographical Collections (preprint)**. Leipzig University, May 2017. Published in *Speculum* 92 (2017). » [PDF](#) · [Published version](#)
- 2016 **Observations of a Medieval Quantitative Historian? (preprint)**. Leipzig University, September 2016. Published in *Der Islam* 94 (2017). » [PDF](#) · [Published version](#)
- 2015 **Classical Arabic Through the Words of the Prophet: A Frequency-Based Ḥadīth Reader**. Perseus Project & Department of Classics, Tufts University, 2015. A computationally generated introduction to the language of Ḥadīth (205 pages). [[key](#)] » [PDF](#) · [How it was made](#)
- 2014 **After the Classical World: The Social Geography of Islam (661–1300 CE) (working paper)**. Tufts University, April 2014. Published in *Ars Islamica* (2016). » [PDF](#) · [Published version](#)  
data, software, and digital publications
- 2023 **OpenITI: A Machine-Readable Corpus of Islamicate Texts, Primary Version 2023.1.8**. Lorenz Nigst, Maxim Romanov, Sarah Bowen Savant, Masoumeh Seydi, and Peter Verkinderen. Zenodo, 2023. Data set. About 8,700 unique titles by over 3,300 authors; some 861 million words (2.4 billion with all versions). [[key](#)] » [DOI](#) · [GitHub](#) · [Documentation](#)
- 2025 **ADHFAIS Appendix 1: OpenITI NgramReader (based on OpenITI, release 2023.1.8), version 1**. Zenodo, 2025. An online application for tracing the use of words and phrases across the Arabic written tradition; companion to *Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies*. [[key](#)] » [Application](#) · [DOI](#)
- 2025 **ADHFAIS Appendix 2: M10 Book Classification (based on OpenITI, release 2023.1.8), version 1**. Zenodo, 2025. An experiment in soft classification of the works of the Arabic written tradition against ten types of texts. The application uses the T10 typological model of the book; “M10” in the published title is the same model (M for model). [[key](#)] » [Application](#) · [DOI](#)
- 2014 ongoing **al-Ṭurayyā Project: Gazetteer and Geospatial Model of the Early Islamic World**. Maxim

**Romanov** and Masoumeh Seydi. althurayya.github.io. Over 2,000 toponyms and route sections geo-referenced from Georgette Cornu's *Atlas du monde arabo-islamique à l'époque classique*. [\[key\]](#) » [Website](#)

2014 ongoing **OpenITI mARkdown: A Light-Weight Annotation Scheme for Arabic-Script Texts**. Structural, morphological, and semantic tagging designed as a research method; the format of the OpenITI corpus. [\[key\]](#) » [Description](#) · [Editor highlighting \(Kate\)](#)

2015 **betaCode for Arabic: Conversion Routines**. Python scripts for typing fully vocalized Arabic in ASCII and converting it into Arabic script and several transliteration schemes. » [GitHub](#) · [Read the note](#)

## Invited Talks, Guest Lectures, Keynotes

- September 2026: Germany **Digital Scholarly Communications...**, Keynote at *Beyond the Book: Digital Research, Presentation, and Sustainability*, Freie Universität Berlin, Institute of Arabic Studies, September 21–22, 2026 [\[keynote\]](#)
- June 2026: Spain **Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Proposition for the Field**, Book presentation, invited lecture at the XII Arabic Codicology Summer Course *The Islamic Manuscript Heritage in the El Escorial Collection*, directed by Nuria de Castilla and François Déroche, Real Biblioteca del Monasterio de San Lorenzo de El Escorial, June 2, 2026
- May 2026: Netherlands **Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Proposition for the Field**, Book presentation at a workshop organized by Yusuf Çelik, Faculty of Religion and Theology, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, May 13, 2026
- December 2025: Austria **Modeling Social History of the Islamic World (c. 600–1600 CE) ... with Generative LLMs**, Guest lecture in the *VO DH Ringvorlesung* of Tara Andrews, winter term 2025/26, Universität Wien, December 9, 2025
- April 2025: Turkey · online **Islamicate Digital Humanities: What is it and Why Bother?**, Invited Lecture in the course “Special Topics in Digital History”, invited by Hasan Umut, April 14, Boğaziçi University, Turkey
- November 2024: Germany **Future in the Past: Constructing the Social History of the Premodern Islamic World with Modern Computational Methods**, at *Digital Humanities and Medieval Middle Eastern Texts: Assessments and Perspectives*, November 8, University of Tübingen. Invited by Federico Montinaro
- July 2024: Germany **A Corpus-Driven Approach in Religious Studies: A Case Of Islam**, University of Bochum, July 12, 2024
- July 2024: Germany **Digital Humanities in the context of Religious Studies**, University of Bochum, July 12, 2024
- November 2023: Spain **Teaching Computational Analysis with the ‘Prosopografía de ulemas de al-Andalus’**, at Remembering al-Andalus and the Maghrib in the Mashriq, 23–24 November 2023, Escuela de Estudios Árabes, CSIC, Granada (Spain)
- October 2023: Germany **Arabic biographical collections as a source for modeling social transformations, cultural production, and demography**, at Demography, Economy and Law in (Post-)Imperial Worlds 800 to 1600 – Latin Europe and the Western Islamic World in Comparison, Workshop, at RomanIslam Center, Universität Hamburg, October 17, 2023
- April 2022: Germany **Made by People, Tied by People: Modeling Islamic Urban Networks from Biographical Data (ca. 600–1300 CE)**, Invited Lecture at RomanIslam Center, April 20, 2022
- April 2022: USA **To DB or not to DB: LOD-like Approach and Algorithmic Analysis**, at Digital Praxis in the Humanities (lecture series), Yale University, April 11, 2022
- September 2021: Germany **Prospects of Middle Eastern Studies in the Context of Digital Humanities**, at Third Summer School in Islamicate Digital Humanities for Scholars in Manuscript Studies, August 30 – September 10, 2021 [\[keynote\]](#)
- December 2020: France · online **OpenITI mARkdown: Between Method and Standard**, at Étudier et publier les textes arabes avec le numérique, GIS Asie, études africaines et Moyen-Orient et mondes musulmans. December 8–10, 2020.
- November 2020: Austria **Computational History and Historiography of the Medieval Islamic World**, an invited lecture in *070227–1 Introduction to Digital Humanities (2020W)*, taught by Tara Andrews, University of Vienna, November 24, 2020
- November 2020: Austria **Data Science & Digital Humanities: Modeling Arabic Written Tradition**, an invited lecture in *040172 VU Doing Data Science (MA) (2020W)*, taught by Jan Fabian Ehmke & Yllka Velaj, University of Vienna, January 7, 2020
- January 2020: Austria **Algorithmic Analysis into Social History: A Case of Medieval Islamic History**, an invited lecture in *070227 VO Introduction to Digital Humanities (2019W)*, taught by Tara Andrews, University of Vienna, January 7, 2020
- September 2019: Spain **“The Marvels of Old in the Digital World”: Toward the Methodological Turn in Middle Eastern Studies**, *Knowledge and Power Seminar Series*, Centro de Ciencias Humanas y Sociales, CSIC,

Madrid, September 12, 2019

May 2019: Lebanon **“Digital Dust of the Arabic Past”: Corpus-Based Research in Arabic & Islamic Studies**, Keynote at Digital Humanities Institute 2019, Beirut, May 3–5, 2019 [keynote]

April 2019: Russia **Arabic History & Historiography in the Digital Age**, *invited lecture* at Higher School of Economics, St. Petersburg

February 2019: Hungary **Arabic History & Historiography in the Digital Age**, *invited lecture* at Center for Eastern Mediterranean Studies and OTTOCONFESSIONS, ERC-funded Project (PI Dr. Tijana Krstic), Central European University, Budapest

April 2018: Qatar **“Iftah Yā Simsim!” Finding Digital Keys to the Treasures of the Arabic Written Tradition**, Keynote at “Research Data Management in Digital Humanities”, International Conference, University College London—Doha, April 17–18, 2018 [keynote]

February 2018: Austria **“Open Sesame!” Digital Analysis of the Arabic Written Tradition: Part I—On Social History**, Austrian Academy of Sciences, Vienna, February 6, 2018

May 2017: Netherlands **The Corpus, The Network, & The Book Continuum**, the fifth lecture of the KITAB LUCIS lectures (others given by Sarah Savant), Leiden University Centre for the Study of Islam and Society, Leiden University

May 2017: Netherlands **Computational Reading of Arabic Biographical Collections**, *Invited Lecture* at The Leiden University Centre for Digital Humanities (LUCDH), Leiden University

February 2017: USA **Premodern Arabic Biographical Collections: A Digital Approach**, *Invited Lecture* at University of Pennsylvania

2017: Germany **Arabic Written Tradition & the Digital Humanities**, *Invited lecture*, given at Universität Hamburg (April 24, 2017) and Goethe-Universität Frankfurt am Main (March 24, 2017)

November 2016: USA **From Text to Map: Arabic Biographical Collections and Geospatial Analysis**, *Invited Lecture*, at Center for Geographic Analysis, Harvard University

June 2016: Germany **Future in the Past: Using Modern Computational Methods for the Analysis of Premodern Arabic Texts**, *guest lecture* at “Society and Religion in the Arab World” (an introductory Arabic and Islamic Studies seminar taught by Marie Hakenberg), Leipzig University

May 2016: Germany **Annotation of Geographical Data**, With Chiara Palladino; Session 14 of Sunoikisis Digital Classics 2016

April 2016: Germany/USA **Discovering Spatial and Chronological Patterns in Historical Texts**, *invited lecture* at Unlocking the Digital Humanities, A Seminar organized by Leipzig University & Tufts University, Spring 2016

2016: USA **Writing a 50-volume book in 14th-century Damascus: Algorithmic Analysis, Text Reuse & the Arabic Written Tradition**, *Invited lecture*, given at Davidson College (November 9, 2016) and the University of Michigan (March 10, 2016)

December 2015: USA/Netherlands **Arabic and Islamic Studies and the Digital Humanities**, The Brill Workshop on the Digital Humanities, Leiden (December 2–3) and Boston (May 1–2)

February 2015: USA **Digital Humanities & the Premodern Islamic World: Of Graphs, Maps, and 30,000 Muslims**, *Invited public lecture*, The Gustav E. von Grunebaum Center for Near Eastern Studies, University of California—Los Angeles, February 25, 2015

2015–2016: USA/Germany/UK **Of Graphs, Maps, and 30,000 Muslims: Premodern Arabic Texts & the Digital Humanities**, *Invited lecture*, given in different versions at the Center for Digital Humanities / Department of History, University of South Carolina (November 14, 2016); Duke University (November 11, 2016); University of Tübingen (May 11, 2016); MITH, University of Maryland (March 2, 2016); University of St Andrews (November 27, 2015); University of Manchester (November 25, 2015); SOAS, University of London (November 23, 2015)

August 2014: USA **The Social Geography of the Islamic World (661–1300 CE): on the Method**, *invited talk* at PROSOP Workshop, Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL (August 15, 2014)

April 2014: USA **Distant Reading of Arabic Biographical Collections**, *guest lecture* at “Saints and Sinners in Muslim Literature” (Mimi Hanaoka) at the University of Richmond, Richmond, VA (April 10, 2014)

April 2014: USA **The Social Geography of the Islamic World (661–1300 CE)**, *invited talk* at the University of Richmond, Richmond, VA (April 10, 2014)

April 2014: USA **Future in the Past: Using Digital Methods to Study Medieval Arabic Texts**, *brown bag lecture* at Tufts University (April 7, 2014).

April 2014: USA **Classical Arabic through the Words of the Prophet: Teaching Classical Arabic in the Digital Age**, *brown bag lecture* at Tufts University (April 2, 2014).

March 2014: USA **Studying Classical Arabic Sources in the Digital Age: Social Geography & Social History**, *invited talk* at Holy Cross Manuscripts, Inscriptions and Documents Club the College of the Holy Cross, Worcester, MA (March 14, 2014)

- February 2014: USA **Building a Historical Gazetteer**, *Guest Lecture* at “Computational methods in the humanities,” An honors course (Prof. David J. Birnbaum) at the University of Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA (February, 21, 2014)
- February 2014: USA **Connectedness of the Islamic World (661–1300 CE)**, *invited talk* at the European Union Center of Excellence & European Studies Center, the University of Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA (February, 20, 2014)
- 2014: USA **Computational Reading of Classical Arabic Sources: the Case of Biographical Collections**, *Invited talk*, given at the Department of Classics, Tufts University (March 10, 2014); Bard College, Annandale-on-Hudson, NY (February 11, 2014); and the Center for Digital Research in the Humanities, University of Nebraska–Lincoln (January 30, 2014)
- ### Conference Papers and Presentations
- July 2026: Belgium **Out of How Many? Numerator Without / With Denominator**, at the Seventeenth Meeting of the School of Abbasid Studies, KU Leuven, July 14–18, 2026
- October 2024: UK **Navigating Seas of Biographies: A Computational Pipeline for Biography Identification in Historical Corpora (EIS1600 Project Paper)**, together with Alicia González Martínez (*delivered the presentation*), Tariq Yousef, and Hamid Reza Hakimi, at the *Arabic Pasts 2024: Histories and Historiographies*, October 3–5, 2024, at Aga Khan University, Institute for the Study of Muslim Civilizations.
- September 2024: Germany **Data-Driven Periodization of Classical Arabic and the Arabic Written Tradition**, at the *Societies in Transition: Law, Culture and Politics in the Middle East (30th International DAVO Congress)*, University of Göttingen, September 26–28, 2024
- September 2024: Germany **A Book of 30,000 Biographies: Computational Analysis of Sources of “The History of Islam” of al-Dahabī (d. 748/1348)**, at *Textual Transmission in the Islamic Manuscript Age: On the Variance, Reception, and Usage of Arabic and Persian Works from the Middle East to the Indian Subcontinent*, German-Japanese Bilateral Conference, University of Münster, September 5–7, 2024
- August 2024: Armenia **Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies: what is it and why bother?**, at *Texts, Interpretations, and Entanglements in the Study of Islamicate History*, International Conference at the Yerevan State University, August 28–30, 2024
- June 2024: USA **Modeling Social History: A Deep Learning Approach to Arabic Historical Tradition**, together with Alicia González Martínez, Tariq Yousef (*delivered the presentation*), and Hamid Reza Hakimi, at *DH 2024: Reinvention & Responsibility*, the annual conference of the Alliance of Digital Humanities Organizations, at The Roy Rosenzweig Center for History and New Media, Arlington, VA / Washington, D.C., August 6–9, 2024, Published: <<https://tinyurl.com/DH2024-MSH>>.
- June 2024: Germany **Text Reuse in the Arabic Written Tradition: A Case of Biographical Collections**, at *Making of a Sage: Corpora of Wise Sayings in a Religio-Historical Perspective*, International Workshop at Göttingen University, organized by Ute Pietruschka, June 28–29, 2024
- March 2024: UAE **Computational typology of texts as a means of modeling the development of the Arabic written tradition**, at *The Praxis of Digital Humanities: Expanding Horizons and Transforming Scholarship in the Arab/Islamic world*, a symposium, March 6–7, 2024, Department of Arabic and Translation Studies (ATS), American University of Sharjah (AUS)
- December 2023: Japan **Şundūq al-ġarā’ib fī-l-‘aṣr al-raġā’im: Reading Medieval Texts in the Digital Age**, at The Middle East and Europe, 1097–1517, Waseda University, Tokyo, 9–10 December, 2023
- October 2023: UK **Modelling the Development of Premodern Islamic Societies from Biographical and Historical Data**, (together with: Hamid Reza Hakimi, Lisa Mischer, and Tariq Yousef), at Arabic Pasts 2023, 5–6 October 2023, Aga Khan University—London
- September 2023: Bulgaria **Enhancing State-of-the-Art NLP Models for Classical Arabic**, together with Tariq Yousef, Lisa Mischer (*delivered presentation*), and Hamid Reza Hakimi, at Ancient Language Processing Workshop, at Recent Advances in Natural Language Processing, September 8, Varna, Bulgaria
- June 2023: USA **OpenITI mARkdown: Balancing Between a Standard and a Research Method**, at Digital Publication of Right-to-Left Script Corpora, June 29–30, 2023; The University of Maryland, College Park, MD, USA
- June 2023: Germany **Finding and Linking Information in Arabic Historical Texts**, (together with Lisa Mischer, Hamid Reza Hakimi, Tariq Yousef), at Data Linking Workshop 2023: Computer Vision and Natural Language Processing – Challenges in the Humanities, Center for the Study of Manuscript Cultures, Universität Hamburg, June 27–28, 2023
- March 2023: Germany **Algorithmic Analysis into Social History**, at LOOP Workshop, Ruhr Universität Bochum, March, 9–10, 2023
- September 2022: Germany **Similarity-Based Networks for Islamicate Digital Humanities**, at “Computational Contri-

- contributions to the Social and Cultural Histories of the Islamicate World”, a *Panel*, co-organized with Till Grallert, at 34. Deutscher Orientalistentag 12.-17.09.2022, Freie Universität Berlin (100 Jahre DOT)
- July 2022: Germany **Modeling the Development of Premodern Islamic Societies through Computational Analysis of Written Sources**, at Linked Open Tafsir Conference 2022, July 18 -20, 2022, Bad Homburg, Germany
- October 2021: Germany **Being Pragmatic: Data and Authority Files in the OpenITI Corpus**, at <AUTHOR><TITLE><PLAC Authority Records and Manuscripts in Libraries and Research (hybrid workshop), a workshop co-organised by the “Orient-Digital” project at Berlin State Library and “Bibliotheca Arabica” (Saxon Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Leipzig) October 27–29, 2021
- October 2021: online **OpenITI: The Corpus for The Field**, at “Digitalizing Humanities. Humanizing digitalization”, online congress, organized by Enrique Capdevila (*Petrifying Wealth-IH*) and Arturo Guerrero (*EuQu-ILC*), October 20–21, 2021
- October 2020: USA · online **One Source to Rule Them All: Constructing the Master Chronicle for Islamic History**, at Middle East Studies Association 54th Annual Meeting (online), October 5–17, 2020
- October 2020: USA · online **Big Data and Mega Corpora in the Middle East Studies: The Case of Arabic Written Tradition**, at Middle East Studies Association 54th Annual Meeting (online), October 5–17, 2020
- August 2020: Germany · online **Digital Humanities with non-European sources: The Case of Arabic**, at “Hack the Middle East”: an Introduction to Digital Humanities, an Online Workshop, *Die Junge Akademie*, August 11–12, 2020
- July 2020: Germany · online **OpenITI**, at Digitalisierungsworkshop der orientalistischen Fächer BA/ER (Workshop on Digital Tools in Oriental Studies BA/ER), Universität Bamberg & Universität Erlangen, July 4, 2020
- October 2019: USA/UK **Something Old, Something New, Something Borrowed: Computational Analysis of Writing Practices of Islamic Scholars**, at: • Middle East Studies Association 53rd Annual Meeting, November 14–17, New Orleans, LA, USA; • Arabic Pasts: Histories and Historiography, 17–19 October 2019, Aga Khan University, London
- July 2019: Netherlands **Open Islamicate Texts Initiative: A Machine-Readable Corpus of Texts Produced in the Premodern Islamicate World**, at Digital Humanities 2019, Utrecht University, July 9–12 (In collaboration with: Matthew Thomas Miller, Sarah Bowen Savant, and Masoumeh Seydi)
- July 2019: Netherlands **al-Ṭurayyā, the Gazetteer and the Geo-Spatial Model of the Early Islamic World**, at Digital Humanities 2019, Utrecht University, July 9–12 (In collaboration with: Masoumeh Seydi, who also presented)
- July 2019: Netherlands **Orbis-in-a-box (OIB): Modeling Historical Geographical Networks**, at Digital Humanities 2019, Utrecht University, July 9–12 (In collaboration with: Masoumeh Seydi, James Ballie, Karl Grossner, and Rainer Simon)
- June 2019: Japan · online **Computational Historiography: al-Ḍahabī’s *Taʾrīḥ al-islām* and His Sources**, at the Sixth Conference of the *School of Mamluk Studies*, Tokyo, Japan, June 15–17 2019
- April 2019: Russia **Interconnectedness of Texts and Computational Modeling of the Arabic Written tradition**, (in Russian: “Преемственность текстов и компьютерное моделирование арабской письменной традиции”), at The 41st Annual Session of St Petersburg Arabists, The Institute of Oriental Manuscripts of the Russian Academy of Sciences. April 8–10, 2019.
- February 2019: UK **Modeling Society from Text: a Method in Arabic Studies**, at Decoding the Past. Digital Tools for the Analysis of Historical Data, a *Workshop*, University of London, February 21–22, 2019
- December 2018: Spain **al-Ḍahabī’s treatment of his Andalusī sources: toward understanding of compilation methods of medieval historians**, at *The Maghrib in the Mashriq* (i.e.: *Islamic West in Islamic East*), a congress, Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Madrid, 20–21 December 2018
- December 2018: Netherlands **Prospects of Corpus-Based Research: Computational Methods and the OpenITI Corpus**, at *Whither Islamicate Digital Humanities*, Academy Colloquium, The Royal Netherlands Academy of Arts and Sciences, Amsterdam, 13–15 December 2018 (organized by Christian Lange & Melle Lyklema, Utrecht University)
- May 2018: Italy **Modeling Arabic Written Tradition: Enhancing Traditional Text analysis with Computational Techniques**, at *Launching RASCIO: Reader, Author, Scholar in Context of Information Overflow*, a Workshop organized by Dr. Élise Franssen, Università Ca’ Foscari Venezia, May 24, 2018
- November 2017: USA **Looking for the author behind the words: Stylometric Analysis of al-Ḍahabī’s (d. 1347) Writings**, at *A New Corpus for the Islamicate World and Methods for Its Exploration*, a Panel co-organized by Sarah Savant and Matthew Miller, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.
- October 2017: Austria **Modeling Social History of the Premodern Islamic World**, at Evolution of Social Complexity, a Workshop organized by Complexity Science Hub Vienna, October 2–3, 2017

- September 2017: Spain **Digital Humanities in the field of Islamic studies**, at Digital Humanities & the History of al-Andalus and the Maghreb: Challenges and Opportunities, a Research Seminar at Escuela de Estudios Árabes—Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas (CSIC), Cuesta del Chapiz, 22, Granada
- May 2017: Italy **Why do we need a corpus and computational methods?**, at Navigating the House of Wisdom: How to write a good book in the medieval Middle East, a Workshop at the University of Milan, May 25th–26th 2017.
- April 2017: United Arab Emirates **Algorithmic Analysis of Premodern Arabic Biographical Collections: Approach, Infrastructure, Open Data**, at Digital Humanities Abu Dhabi—DHAD, a Workshop at New York University Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates, 10–12 April 2017
- January 2017: Germany **80/20: Facilitating Computational Analysis with Named-Entities Recognition**, at Digital Infrastructure for Named Entities Data, a Workshop, Leipzig University, January 11–13, 2017
- December 2016: Spain **An Accidental Gazetteer: Linked Data for Historical Geography of the Classical Islamic World**, at Linked Pasts 2016, a symposium series dedicated to facilitating practical and pragmatic developments in Linked Open Data in History, Classics, Geography and Archaeology, December 15–16, 2016 (hosted at: Universidad Nacional de Educación a Distancia, Madrid)
- November 2016: USA **Of A Network and A Node: ‘The History of Islam’ of al-Dahabī (d. 1348) and its place in the Premodern Arabic Textual Tradition**, at *Networked Texts: New Ways of Seeing the Arabic Textual Tradition (750–1500)*, a Panel co-organized by Sarah Savant and Maxim Romanov, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Boston, MA
- September 2016: USA **Presentation on Islamic[ate] DH Projects at Leipzig University**, at Activism, Advocacy, and Scholarship on Islam in the Digital Realm: Prospects, Progress, and Challenges, a workshop organized by the Institute for the Study of Muslim Societies & Civilizations, Boston University (September 16 & 17, 2016)
- October 2015: USA **“al-Dahabī’s Monster”: Dissecting a 50-Volume Arabic Chronicle-cum-Biographical Collection from the 14th Century CE**, at *Distant Reading & the Islamic Archive*, Conference at Brown University, October 16, 2015
- September 2015: UK **The *Ta’rīḥ al-islām* of al-Dahabī (d. 748/1347 CE): Computational Exploration of the Life-Cycle of a 50-Volume Arabic Chronicle-cum-Biographical Collection**, at Arabic Pasts: Histories and Historiographies: Research Workshop, co-hosted by the Aga Khan University, Institute for the Study of Muslim Civilisations and SOAS, University of London (September 25–26, 2015)
- July 2015: USA **Cultural Production in the Islamic World (600–1900 CE): mining an Ottoman bibliographical collection from the early 20th century**, at The Keystone Digital Humanities Conference, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA (July 22–24, 2015)
- May 2015: USA **Analyzing Arabic Biographical Collections at Scale**, at Digital Ottoman Platform Workshop, Institute for Advanced Study, Princeton, NJ (June 8–12, 2015)
- May 2015: USA **The Writing Culture of Nishāpūr in the 11th Century**, [In collaboration with Sarah Savant, Aga Khan University, London; paper delivered by Sarah Savant], at Iranian Cities from the Arab Conquest to the Early Modern Period, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA (May 1–2).
- November 2014: USA **Exploring Islamic Written Legacy: Computational Reading of *Hadiyyat al-ʿarīfīn***, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.
- March 2014: USA **Computational Processing of Toponymic Data from classical Arabic Sources**, at Working with Text in a Digital Age, A Workshop at Tufts University (the Perseus Project) (March 29, 2014).
- February 2014: USA **Visualizing Islamic Geography at Scale**, at Data Big and Small: Computer Science, the Humanities and Social Science: Conversations between representatives from Leipzig, Northeastern, Princeton & Tufts, a workshop at Tufts University (the Perseus Project) (February 3–4, 2014).
- October 2013: USA **Abstract Models for Islamic History**, at Digital Humanities and Islamic & Middle Eastern Studies, Brown University, Providence, RI (October 24–25, 2013).
- October 2013: USA **Islamic World Connected (661–1300 CE)**, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA.
- April 2013: USA **Toward Abstract Models for Islamic History**, Poster at *Word, Space, Time: Digital Perspectives on the Classical World*, an interdisciplinary conference organized by the Digital Classics Association, University at Buffalo, SUNY, April 5–6, 2013
- March 2013: USA **Exploratory Analysis of Arabic Biographical Collections: the Case of al-Dahabī’s (d. 1347 CE) *Ta’rīḥ al-islām***, at: • the 223rd Meeting of the American Oriental Society (AOS), Portland, OR; • the 8th Annual Pearl Kibre Medieval Study Conference: “New Media and the Middle Ages”, The Graduate Center, CUNY, New York, NY.
- February 2013: USA **«Connectedness» of the Islamic World (600–1300 CE)**, at 7th Annual Near Eastern Studies Graduate Student Colloquium, U of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI.

- November 2012: USA* **Social History of the Muslim World in the Digital Age: Making Sense of 29,000 Biographies from al-Dahabī's «History of Islam»**, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.
- November 2012: USA* **Social History of the Muslim World in the Digital Age: Making Sense of 29,000 Biographies from al-Dahabī's «History of Islam»**, at Cyberinfrastructure Days, University of Michigan, November 7–8, 2012. Received: “People’s Choice Award Winner”
- October 2012: USA* **Writing the Digital History of the Premodern Muslim World, 670–1300 CE: Exploratory Analysis of Primary Sources**, at Interdisciplinary Workshop under the rubric “Forum on Research in Medieval Studies” (FoRMS), the Medieval Lunch Series, University of Michigan.
- August 2012: USA* **Mining pre-Modern Islamic Sources**, at “Working with Text in a Digital Age,” the summer institute at Tufts U, Medford, MA.
- April 2012: Russia* **Dreaming Ḥanbalites: Dream-Tales in Prosopographical Dictionaries**, (in Russian), at the 34th Annual Session of St. Petersburg Arabists, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS.
- April 2012: Belgium* **Digital History of the Muslim World: Computer-Aided Analysis of Biographical Dictionaries**, at Methods and means for digital analysis of ancient and medieval texts and manuscripts, a workshop at the Katholieke Universiteit, Leuven & the Royal Flemish Academy of Belgium (KVAB), Brussels.
- November 2010: USA* **«Popular» Preaching in the Sunnī Context and the Legitimization of Waḥ in the Late 12th Century CE**, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, San Diego, CA.
- November 2009: USA* **Aḥmad b. Ḥanbal's (d. 241/855) Argumentative Strategies**, at Middle East Studies Association (MESA) Annual Meeting, Boston, MA.
- April 2009: USA* **Dreaming Ḥanbalites**, at Dreams and Visions in Islamic Societies, conference, University of Michigan.
- March 2004: Russia* **The Origins of the Term Ṣūfī**, (in Russian), at the 26th Annual Session of St. Petersburg Arabists, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS.
- December 2003: Russia* **The Paradigm of the Science of Ḥadīṭ (ʿilm al-ḥadīṭ)**, (in Russian), at the Annual Academic Session, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS.
- April 2003: Russia* **Argumentation with Ḥadīṭ Reports in Ibn al-Jawzī's Talbīs Iblīs (“Devil’s Delusions”)**, (in Russian), at the 25th Annual Session of St. Petersburg Arabists, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS
- April 2002: Russia* **Ibn al-Jawzī's Image in the Western Scholarship**, (in Russian), at the 24th Annual Session of St. Petersburg Arabists, SPbIOS/IOM of RAS.

### Panels, Workshops, and Roundtables Organized

- July 2025: Germany* **From Classical ML to AI in Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Hands-On Workshop**, (part of EIS1600 project activities), a 4-day workshop at *Afrika-Asien Institut*, Universität Hamburg (EIS1600 Project), with Tariq Yousef, Ryan Muther, and Alicia González Martínez. Funding: DFG, EIS1600 Emmy Noether Project
- September 2024: Germany* **Stylometry and the Digital Humanities: Unraveling Authorship and Periodization in Arabic Textual Traditions**, a *panel* co-organized with Till Grallert and Maroussia Bednarkiewicz at the 30th International Congress of Deutsche Arbeitsgemeinschaft Vorderer Orient (DAVO), Göttingen, 26–28 September 2024
- September 2022: Germany* **Computational Contributions to the Social and Cultural Histories of the Islamicate World**, a *panel* co-organized with Till Grallert, at: 34. Deutscher Orientalistentag 12.-17.09.2022, Freie Universität Berlin (100 Jahre DOT)
- July 2020: Austria/UK · online* **Stylometry Workshop with Maciej Eder**, Department of History, University of Vienna & The KITAB Project, Aga Khan University, London. July 1–3, 2020.
- June 2019: Japan* **Approaching Mamlūk Historiography: Narratologically, Literarily, Computationally**, a panel at the Sixth Conference of the School of Mamlūk Studies, Waseda University, Tokyo, June 15–17, 2019
- July 2018: Austria* **ORBIS-esque Hackathon**, Department of History, University of Vienna (co-organized with Tara Andrews and Mária Varga); planning document: [tinyurl.com/orbis-esque](https://tinyurl.com/orbis-esque).
- November 2017: USA* **A New Corpus for the Islamicate World and Methods for Its Exploration**, a *panel* co-organized with Dr. Sarah Savant (AKU–London) and Dr. Matthew Thomas Miller (UMD) at MESA, Washington, DC–2017
- November 2016: USA* **Networked Texts: New Ways of Seeing the Arabic Textual Tradition (750–1500)**, a *panel* co-organized with Dr. Sarah Savant (AKU–London), MESA, Boston–2016
- November 2016: USA* **Non-traditional methods for Teaching Traditional Languages**, a *roundtable* at the annual meeting of the Middle East Studies Association (MESA), Boston 2016

- December 2015: Germany* **Analyzing Text Reuse at Scale / Working with Big Humanities Data**, at Leipzig University, organized by Thomas Köntges & Maxim Romanov (within the framework of Leipzig Workshop Week, 14–18 December 2015).
- December 2015: Germany* **Digital Arabic and Digital Persian Research Workshop**, at Leipzig University, organized by Maxim Romanov (within the framework of Leipzig Workshop Week, 14–18 December 2015).
- November 2013: USA* **Digital Humanities in Middle East Studies**, (organized together with Børre Ludvigsen and Will Hanley), a series of two panels and a roundtable: “Traditional Sources, Nontraditional Methods,” “Digital Communication,” and Roundtable at the annual meeting of the Middle East Studies Association (MESA), New Orleans 2013.
- November 2010: USA* **Islamic Preaching**, a panel at the annual meeting of the Middle East Studies Association (MESA), San Diego, 2010

## Teaching

- 2023–2024 **Computational Analysis of Data from Audition Certificates, with R**, Universität Hamburg · Winter 2023/24 · Historical methods · DH » [Course site](#)
- 2023 **Digital Humanities in African-Asian Studies: Analysis of Prosopographical Data with R**, Universität Hamburg · Summer 2023 · Historical methods · DH » [Course site](#)
- 2022 **Text Analysis in R**, Universität Hamburg · Summer 2022 · Historical methods · DH » [Course site](#)
- 2022 **Digital Humanities in Middle Eastern Studies**, Universität Hamburg · Winter 2021/22 · Historical methods · DH » [Course site](#)
- 2021 **GIS Inquiries with R**, University of Vienna · Summer 2021 (SE seminar, PM 3) · GIS · DH » [Course site](#)
- 2017–2020 **DH Methods: Historical Inquiries with R**, University of Vienna · Summer 2020 (text analysis module), Summer 2019, Winter 2017/18 (SE seminar, PM 3) · Historical methods · DH » [Course site \(2020\)](#)
- 2018–2020 **Tools and Techniques for Digital Humanities**, University of Vienna · Winter 2020, Summer 2019, Summer 2018 (KU Methodenkurs) · DH
- 2018 **Of Arabs, Persians and Turks: Patterns of Dynastic Rule in the Islamic World (c. 600–1600 CE)**, University of Vienna · Summer 2018 (MA Proseminar) · History
- 2017–2018 **The Near East at the Time of the First Crusade, 1045–1144**, University of Vienna · Winter 2017/18 (BA Proseminar), co-taught with Tara Andrews · History
- 2017–2018 **The Medieval Near East and Europe according to Muslims, Christians, and Jews: Comparative Perspectives**, University of Vienna · Winter 2017/18 (seminar), co-taught with Tara Andrews · History
- 2016–2017 **Islamicate World 2.0: Studying Islamic Cultures through Computational Textual Analysis**, University of Maryland (College Park) and Leipzig University · Winter 2016/17, co-taught with Matthew Thomas Miller · Islamicate texts · DH
- 2015 **Classical Arabic Through the Words of the Prophet**, Tufts University · Spring 2015 · Classical Arabic · DH
- 2014–2015 **Introduction to Text Mining for Students of the Humanities**, Tufts University · 2014–2015 · Text analysis · DH
- 2014 **Mapping the Classical Islamic World**, Tufts University · Winter 2014 · History · DH
- 2012 **The First Millennium of the Islamic Near East, 600–1600 CE**, University of Michigan · Fall 2012, as teaching assistant for Michael Bonner · History · DH
- 2010–2011 **Introduction to Islam**, University of Michigan · Spring 2011, Winter 2011 (as teaching assistant for Sherman Jackson), Spring 2010 · Religion · History
- 2007–2010 **Elementary Modern Standard Arabic**, University of Michigan · 2007–2010 · Language
- 2006–2007 **Elementary Classical Arabic**, University of Michigan · 2006–2007 · Classical language

## Workshops and Summer Schools Taught

- June 2026: Spain* **Dialogue as Scholarly Practice: the Socratic Method in the Age of AI**, A 2-day workshop for scholars of Arabic, Islamic, and Middle Eastern studies on working with large language models without programming, at the Instituto de Lenguas y Culturas del Mediterráneo y Oriente Próximo (ILC), CCHS-CSIC, Madrid, June 8–9, 2026, with Alicia González Martínez and Hamid Reza Hakimi; the book *Digital Humanities for Arabic and Islamic Studies* was presented in the closing session
- September 2025: Switzerland* **Summer School on Digital Humanities for Islamic Studies**, University of Bern, September 1–4, 2025. Organizers: Tobias Hodel and Serena Tolino

- July 2025: Germany **From Classical ML to AI in Arabic and Islamic Studies: A Hands-On Workshop**, A 4-day workshop at the Asien-Afrika-Institut, Universität Hamburg, organized within EIS1600 with Tariq Yousef, Ryan Muther, and Alicia González Martínez
- September 2024: Germany **Introduction to Digital Humanities in Islamic Studies: A Hands-On Training**, A 1-day workshop at the Seminar für Arabistik/Islamwissenschaft, Universität Göttingen, with Jens Scheiner, September 25, 2024
- September 2024: Spain **Computational Analysis of Andalusian Prosopography**, A 5-day workshop on the *Prosopografía de ulemas de al-Andalus* ([eea.csic.es/pua](http://eea.csic.es/pua)) at the Escuela de Estudios Árabes, Granada, with Mayte Penelas and Maribel Fierro, as part of the project *Al-Andalus y el Magrib en el Oriente islámico: movilidad, migración y memoria* (AMOI-II)
- December 2023: Japan **Intensive Workshop in Islamic Digital Humanities**, A 2-day workshop organized with Wakako Kumakura, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, December 16–17, 2023
- July 2018: Belgium **Digital Islamic Humanities: A 3-Day Intensive Course**, Ghent University, July 2–4, 2018, in collaboration with the Ghent Centre for Digital Humanities. Plan and materials: [dih-sms2018-ughent.github.io](https://dih-sms2018-ughent.github.io)
- November 2017: Netherlands **Workshop on Digital Humanities in Islamic and Arabic Studies**, SENSIS ERC Project (PI Christian Lange), Utrecht University, November 30–December 1, 2017
- July 2016: Germany **From Text to Map**, A two-week intensive introduction (32 contact hours) to working with humanities data in digital mapping environments, co-taught with David J. Wrisley (American University of Beirut) at *Culture & Technology*, the European Summer University in Digital Humanities, Leipzig University
- February 2015: USA **Digital Humanities & Islamic Studies**, University of California, Los Angeles. Organized by Asma Sayeed and the Gustav E. von Grunebaum Center for Near Eastern Studies
- October 2014: USA **Textual Corpora and the Digital Islamic Humanities**, Brown University; session leader together with Elli Mylonas, organized by Elias Muhanna ([details](#))

## Supervision

- 2025–: Ph.D. **Hamid Reza Hakimi**, *Patterns in the Financial History of the Islamic World (1–1000 AH / 600–1600 CE): Computational Analysis of Data from Chronicles*, Universität Hamburg, African and Asian Studies (main advisor)
- 2022: M.A. **Lisa Mischer**, *A Digital Humanities Approach to Biographical Dictionaries from the Arabic Written Tradition: Extraction and Enrichment of Historical Data*, Universität Leipzig, Digital Humanities (external advisor)
- 2022: B.A. **M. Xenia Kudela**, *Measuring Style: Stylometric Analysis of Collaborative Authorship between Ṭāhā Ḥusayn and Tawfīq al-Ḥakīm in “The Enchanted Castle” (al-Qaṣr al-maṣhūr)*, Freie Universität Berlin, Arabic Studies (external advisor)
- 2022: Ph.D. **Masoumeh Seydi**, *Geospatial Analysis and Modeling of Textual Descriptions of Pre-modern Geography*, Universität Leipzig, Computer Science / Digital Humanities (external advisor)
- 2015: B.A. Honors **Cameron Jackson**, *An Interactive Map of the Classical Islamic World*, Tufts University, Computer Science and Arabic Studies

## Third-Party Funding

- 2021–2027 Emmy Noether Programme Grant, German Research Foundation (DFG). About €1,900,000
- 2012–2013 Charlotte W. Newcombe Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship, Woodrow Wilson National Fellowship Foundation. \$24,000
- 2012 Rackham Research Fellowship, University of Michigan. \$3,000

## Fellowships, Awards, and Honors

- 2015–2016 Research Fellowship (Visiting Fellow), Islamic Legal Studies Program, Harvard Law School (declined)
- 2013 Hajja Razia Sharif Sheikh Scholarship Award in Islamic Studies, University of Michigan

## Service to the Field

- 2021, 2023, 2025 Panel member (SH5 “Cultures and Cultural Production”), ERC Consolidator Grant calls, European Research Council
- 2015– Reviewer for journals and funding bodies at the intersection of digital humanities, Arabic and Islamic studies, and history. Recent reviews for *Journal of Abbasid Studies*, *Journal of Digital Islamic Research*, *Digital Scholarship in the Humanities*, *Temenos*, *Journal of Law and Religion*
- 2013– Regular consultation on the design of digital projects in the historical study of the Islamic world, including over a dozen ERC-funded and academy projects in the US, Canada, the UK, the Netherlands,

Belgium, Spain, Italy, Israel, Japan, Austria, and Germany

## Professional Membership

*2024–* Union Européenne des Arabisants et Islamisants (UEAI)  
*2023–* School of Abbasid Studies (SAS)  
*2016–* Middle East Medievalists (MEM)  
*2012–* American Oriental Society (AOS)  
*2008–* Middle East Studies Association (MESA)

## Skills

*Languages* Russian (native) · Arabic (advanced, modern standard and classical) · English (near-native) · German (B1) · French (reading)  
*Computing* R, Python, QGIS, LaTeX; cluster computing; machine learning